

Anti-spyware Tools

Infected? Removing spyware isn't always as simple as just running an anti-spyware scanner. There are various problems one faces during this process, here are solutions to some of them

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Anti-spyware And A Slow PC

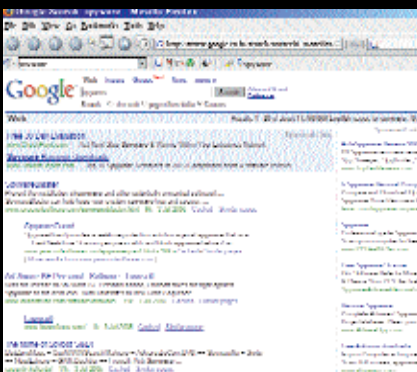
Problem: Anti-spyware doesn't seem to make much difference with a slowed-down computer.

Solution: Always use authentic anti-spyware software. Never trust sponsored links.

There are quite a few recommended anti-spyware software, and few of those are free. We recommend Lavasoft's Ad-Aware SE Personal, available at www.lavasoft.com

When you do a search for 'spyware' on Google, you come up with more than 17 million results, and several sponsored links. Several of those links are suspect.

They may lead you to pages that offer you spyware-removal software for a fee which either don't work in the manner described or are not worth the money you paid for them. Worse still, they may install additional spyware on your system!



The links on the right are sponsored links. Don't always trust what you see here

Heavily-infected PC

Problem: Computer is heavily infected and incredibly slow.

Solution: Re-install your OS.

In some cases, say, when you have been using your computer for a long

time and have never scanned it for spyware and are using an outdated virus definitions file, virus and spyware infections may come in before you can download the requisite software.

Moreover, when the spyware has become an integral part of your system, even a computer technician can't get rid of the spyware. At this point, it is better to just back up what you need and have the OS reinstalled.

Unable To Delete Infected Files

Problem: Files even after detection don't get deleted.

Solution: Manually remove them.

There is detailed information at <http://snipurl.com/g22q> on how to remove a wide variety of existing spyware and adware.

On the page, scroll down to where it says 'Manual Removal'. Here, you will see information on several spyware programs, what they do, and how to remove them.

This might come in handy if, for instance, you see AdAware detecting spyware, and then when you press the 'Delete' button, you find that not everything in the list has been deleted.

This could happen because some spyware 'know' about anti-spyware programs, and entrench themselves in your system more firmly than others do.

Unable To Spot All Spyware

Problem: All spyware is not detected.

Solution: Use two different anti-spyware software.

It's always a good idea to use two different software. One will catch what the other one misses, and vice-versa.

For example, there's AdAware SE and SpyBot. These programs are "highly recommended" by TechTV and other computer authorities, and they complement each other.

Common Spyware Infections And Time-consuming Scanning

Problem: Spyware infections are too common and scanning takes a lot of time.

Solution: Use a pre-emptive filter.

If you are willing to pay, you can use software that catches spyware *before* it infects your computer. This may often be a better approach than, say, scanning for spyware once in two weeks.

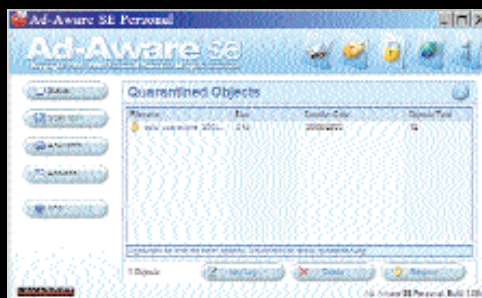
For instance, Ad-Aware SE Plus (not Ad-Aware SE Personal), which costs \$27 (around Rs 1,175), offers more proactive features, including real-time monitoring for pop-up ads and spyware.

Ad-Aware SE Plus prevents browser hijacking, and also prohibits Web site-based ActiveX programs from getting installed on your computer. ■

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Ad-Aware often finds several suspect items...



...but doesn't completely eliminate all of them